

Righteous In Christ

Introduction

One of the most important questions in the Christian faith is whether a person is truly right with God. Many believers struggle with feelings of guilt and unworthiness even after accepting Christ. However, Scripture teaches that believers are not “almost righteous” or “partially righteous”. Instead, they are declared to be the righteousness of God in Christ. This message explains three key truths about being righteous in Christ. It explains the source of our righteousness, the means of receiving righteousness, and the result of righteousness in our lives.

I. The Source of our Righteousness - It comes from Christ, not us.

According to 2 Corinthians 5:21, “For he hath made him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in him.” This verse describes what is often called the “Great Exchange”. Jesus, who was sinless, took upon Himself the sin of Humanity. In return, those who believe in Him receive His righteousness. This righteousness is not something earned through moral behaviour, religious practice, or personal effort.

Romans 3:23 states that all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God. Therefore, no one possesses righteousness on their own. Human effort cannot achieve a holy standing before God. Righteousness is a gift that comes solely from Christ's finished work on the cross. This means believers do not need to strive to earn God's approval. The work has already been completed through Jesus Christ.

II. The Means of our Righteousness - It is received by Faith.

Romans 3:22 explains that righteousness is given “through faith in Jesus Christ to all who believe.” Faith is the method by which righteousness is received. It is not based on performance, but on trust in Christ's sacrifice. Scripture shows this principle in the life of Abraham, who believed God was credited with righteousness. His righteousness was not earned; it was counted to him because of his faith.

This demonstrates that righteousness is credited to believers when they place their trust in Jesus Christ. It is not maintained by personal perfection but secured by Christ's completed work. Therefore, coincidence should rest in what Christ has done rather than in human effort.

III. The Resource of our Righteousness - Living from a New Identity.

In Philippians 3:9, Paul writes about having a righteousness that comes through faith in Christ rather than one based on the law. This teaches an important principle: believers do not work to become righteous in Christ. Righteousness changes identity, and identity influences behavior.

When believers understand their righteous standing before God, they:

1. approach God with confidence
2. Worship without condemnation
3. Resist sin from a place of acceptance
4. Live obediently out of gratitude

Understanding one's identity in Christ leads to bold and faithful Christian living.

Conclusion

The doctrine of righteousness in Christ reveals three important truths:

1. Righteousness comes from Christ alone
2. Righteousness is received through faith
3. Righteousness results in a transformed life

Through Jesus' sacrifice, believers are declared righteous before God. This God provides assurance, confidence, and motivation for holy living. Christians do not strive to earn righteousness; they live in response to righteousness already given to them in Christ.

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